

IMMEDIATE CONTRIBUTION CASE

The role requires an operator who can connect AI, work, change, and evidence.

The job description is unusually explicit: identify real problems, design and test proofs, prepare the business, execute change, groom the portfolio, and capture value. That integrated mandate matches the through-line of my career.

ROLE NEED -> IMMEDIATE CONTRIBUTION

Problem identification and human-centered design

I begin with the workflow, affected people, constraints, decision burden, and current evidence - not a preferred model.

Proof design and testing

I define the problem statement, human authority, evaluation evidence, workflow comparison, adoption owner, and stop criteria together.

Implementation and value creation

I translate prototypes into standard work, ownership, training, feedback, exception handling, and operating measures.

Portfolio management and reporting

I make work visible, prioritize against capacity and evidence, normalize hold/stop decisions, and return reusable learning.

Cross-functional technical translation

I have repeatedly connected executives, frontline operators, engineers, quality teams, customers, and emerging technology.

Change execution

I build mechanisms people can run: cadence, standards, dashboards, escalation, coaching, accountability, and learning loops.

WHAT DIFFERENTIATES THE CONTRIBUTION

I do not separate AI strategy from operating reality.

My direct work spans AI-readiness frameworks, agentic workflow patterns, production and quality systems, ERP and issue flow, robotics and telemetry, customer support, regulated field operations, and high-reliability engineering. That makes me useful at the seams where promising AI initiatives usually lose momentum.

DAY-ONE WORKING POSTURE

Listen before prescribing

Use tactical empathy to understand what the current process protects, not only what it costs.

Make decisions explicit

Clarify authority, evidence, ownership, measures, and stop conditions.

Work directly in the mechanism

Prototype, document, test, facilitate, measure, and iterate alongside the teams doing the work.

Evidence of transferability

Russell Dudek · 412.287.8640 · russelldudek@gmail.com · <https://russelldudek.github.io/highmark/>



VERIFIED CAREER EVIDENCE

Different domains. The same operating problem.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Vape-Jet · Connect signals to accountable work

Current

AI-first transformation across production, purchasing, quality, support, customer success, ERP/Odoo, telemetry, engineering issues, training, and standard work.

DudeWorth · Qualify opportunity before automating momentum

2017-Present

AI-readiness and agentic-workflow frameworks covering value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, human judgment, adoption, evaluation, escalation, and time-to-value.

Amazon · Build mechanisms teams can run

2014-2018

Customer-backward operating routines, standard work, throughput visibility, escalation, labor planning, and closed-loop learning at 24/7 scale.

Compunetics · Translate across high-consequence boundaries

2000-2013

Engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, root cause, process controls, and complex technical programs in high-reliability environments.

WHAT I AM NOT CLAIMING

I am not claiming prior access to Highmark's internal workflows, systems, data, portfolio, or metrics. I am not inventing health-plan results. I am offering a disciplined way to learn the work quickly and connect the exact capabilities J281843 names: problem identification, proof design, business readiness, change execution, implementation, portfolio prioritization, reporting, and value capture.

A LOW-RISK WAY TO TEST THE FIT

FIFTEEN MINUTES. ONE REAL WORKFLOW TENSION.

Give me a sanitized HPO opportunity or the strongest concern about my candidacy. I will map the problem, evidence, authority, adoption, and measurement questions I would use before recommending a proof.

DECISION

Does the thinking improve the conversation?

Does the method fit the work?

Is another interview warranted?

RESPONSIBILITIES MAPPED TO EVIDENCE

Identify and frame

DudeWorth readiness frameworks, human-centered operating analysis, and direct workflow diagnosis at Vape-Jet.

Design and test

Agentic workflow patterns, evaluation, human review, technical documentation, and quality-system discipline.

Implement and adopt

Cross-functional change, standard work, dashboards, training, escalation, and accountability across Amazon, Vape-Jet, and Cardinal.

Prioritize and capture value

Portfolio visibility, capacity decisions, operating measures, reusable learning, and executive communication.

CLOSING POSITION

My differentiating advantage is a rare combination of operations depth, direct AI workflow work, technical-business translation, change execution, quality discipline, and a career built around making complex systems operable. The candidate vision makes that contribution visible and testable.